

30 CHAPTERWISE IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

English Language and Literature (184) | CBSE 2026-27

The Sermon at Benares

First Flight - prose | Board-examinable literature

30 original revision questions with answers: short-answer, competency, assertion-reason and long-answer practice. Set is based on the current syllabus and official question-paper style; it is not a prediction or an official CBSE paper.

Question 1

What lesson does Kisa Gotami learn through her search for mustard seeds?

Answer:

She learns that no household has escaped death. Seeing that grief is shared by all helps her understand the Buddha's teaching that death is a universal part of life.

Question 2

How does the Buddha help Kisa Gotami understand suffering?

Answer:

Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. Her unsuccessful search lets her discover the truth through experience.

Question 3

What is the central message of the chapter about grief?

Answer:

Grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering. Accepting life's impermanence can help a person face loss with greater understanding and peace.

Question 4

What is the central idea or skill tested in The Sermon at Benares?

Answer:

The central focus is: She learns that no household has escaped death. This is the starting point for a strong answer from this chapter.

Question 5

Write two relevant points for a short answer based on The Sermon at Benares.

Answer:

First point: She learns that no household has escaped death. Second point: Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. Link the two points clearly instead of listing them without explanation.

Question 6

How does the first key idea in The Sermon at Benares lead to an important result or conclusion?

Answer:

Begin with the key idea: She learns that no household has escaped death. Then connect it to the result: Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death.

The Sermon at Benares - Continued

Question 7

What evidence, calculation, incident or concept best supports the first main idea in The Sermon at Benares?

Answer:

Use this supporting detail: She learns that no household has escaped death. Seeing that grief is shared by all helps her understand the Buddha's teaching that death is a universal part of life. The relevant detail should be stated before giving the final conclusion.

Question 8

Explain the importance of the second major idea in The Sermon at Benares.

Answer:

Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. Her unsuccessful search lets her discover the truth through experience. Its importance lies in showing how the chapter develops the topic beyond a simple fact or definition.

Question 9

What common mistake should a student avoid while answering a question from The Sermon at Benares?

Answer:

Do not give only a conclusion. Explain the reasoning with a correct detail, such as: Grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering.

Question 10

Compare the first and second important ideas in The Sermon at Benares.

Answer:

The first idea is: She learns that no household has escaped death. The second idea is: Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. A complete comparison states both the difference and the connection between them.

Question 11

Show a cause-and-effect link from The Sermon at Benares.

Answer:

Cause or starting point: She learns that no household has escaped death. Effect or outcome: Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. Use connecting words such as 'therefore', 'as a result', or 'thus'.

Question 12

What is the most useful sequence for explaining the main content of The Sermon at Benares?

Answer:

A clear sequence is: She learns that no household has escaped death. Next, Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. Finally, Grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering.

The Sermon at Benares - Continued

Question 13

Give a 40-50 word answer outline for an important question from The Sermon at Benares.

Answer:

Start with the direct answer: She learns that no household has escaped death. Add one supporting point: Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. End with the outcome or message: Grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering.

Question 14

How should you support an English literature answer from The Sermon at Benares?

Answer:

Use a relevant incident, character action, theme, or poetic image: She learns that no household has escaped death. Then explain what it reveals about the character, situation, or message.

Question 15

How can an examiner see that you understand, rather than memorise, The Sermon at Benares?

Answer:

Connect the idea to its reason or result. For instance: Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. Then explain why this point matters in the chapter's context.

Question 16

State one inference that can be drawn from the main situation or concept in The Sermon at Benares.

Answer:

A sound inference is that grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering. This inference must be supported by a relevant point from the chapter.

Question 17

Frame a short competency-based response using the first two ideas in The Sermon at Benares.

Answer:

Apply the concept by first stating: She learns that no household has escaped death. Then justify the response with: Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death.

Question 18

What would make an answer from The Sermon at Benares incomplete?

Answer:

An answer is incomplete if it omits the explanation or final implication. Include both: She learns that no household has escaped death. Also add: Grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering.

The Sermon at Benares - Continued

Question 19

Prepare an Assertion-Reason style explanation based on The Sermon at Benares.

Answer:

Assertion: She learns that no household has escaped death. Reason: Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. Check whether the reason actually explains the assertion before choosing an option.

Question 20

How should you justify an answer from The Sermon at Benares in two clear steps?

Answer:

Step 1: state the concept or event - She learns that no household has escaped death. Step 2: support it with the explanation or result - Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death.

Question 21

What answer structure is suitable for a 3-mark question from The Sermon at Benares?

Answer:

Use three connected points: She learns that no household has escaped death. Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. Grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering. Keep the points specific and write them in a logical order.

Question 22

What answer structure is suitable for a 5-mark question from The Sermon at Benares?

Answer:

Give an introduction, develop these key points - She learns that no household has escaped death. Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. - and close with: Grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering. Add a diagram, equation, example, or textual reference where relevant.

Question 23

How can the ideas in The Sermon at Benares be applied to a new situation or case study?

Answer:

Identify the relevant principle first: She learns that no household has escaped death. Then use the chapter's reasoning to explain the case: Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death.

Question 24

Which detail from The Sermon at Benares is most likely to earn an extra mark when explained correctly?

Answer:

A useful detail is: Grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering. Explain it in context instead of using it as an isolated statement.

The Sermon at Benares - Continued

Question 25

Write a brief concluding statement for an answer on The Sermon at Benares.

Answer:

A suitable conclusion is: Grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering. This conclusion should follow naturally from the explanation rather than introduce a new point.

Question 26

Make a three-point revision note for The Sermon at Benares.

Answer:

1. She learns that no household has escaped death. 2. Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. 3. Grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering. Revise these points with the chapter's examples, terms, and practice questions.

Question 27

How would you self-check an answer from The Sermon at Benares before submitting it?

Answer:

Check that you have answered the exact question, used the key idea - She learns that no household has escaped death. - and supported it with a reason, example, calculation, or outcome such as: Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death.

Question 28

Why does The Sermon at Benares remain important for revision?

Answer:

It combines factual recall with explanation and application. The main takeaways are: She learns that no household has escaped death. Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. Grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering.

Question 29

Create a final 60-80 word answer plan for a long question from The Sermon at Benares.

Answer:

Opening: She learns that no household has escaped death. Development: Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death. Conclusion: Grief is natural, but clinging to what cannot be changed deepens suffering. Use complete sentences and include all required evidence, steps, or references.

Question 30

What is one last-minute revision question you should ask yourself about The Sermon at Benares?

Answer:

Ask: 'Can I explain why this is true or important?' A correct self-answer should include: She learns that no household has escaped death. and Rather than simply instructing her, he asks her to find mustard seeds from a family untouched by death.

Sources: CBSE English curriculum 2026-27; CBSE Class X sample papers and marking schemes 2026-27; NCERT textbooks.